



Figure 1: Workspace #1



Figure 2: Workspace #2



Figure 3: Workspace #3



Figure 4: Workspace #4

The Maemo desktop

Back on the Maemo (shall I call it) desktop, it asked me to enter my regional settings. I had to enter English UK there... Later, from settings, I could change the time to IST, but not the region to India :-)

On the desktop, things are in a landscape mode—the way a desktop should be—and not portrait that you expect in a phone. The resolution is 800x480. This means you have enough space to fit in a lot of things, and I mean widgets, shortcuts, et al.

Take a look at Figure 1. You can see three website shortcuts for Twitter, Facebook and Google. At the bottom, there's a tile for things provided by Nokia's OVI. Taping the first icon that says OVI, opens the Web browser and takes you to www.ovi.com. This is where you can see all the services that OVI provides. The next icon, which shows a compass, opens the OVI maps application—if you're connected to the Internet, using GPS it can show your location using OVI Maps. The

next three icons are OVI's online services: OVI share, OVI Files, and OVI e-mail.

You need to create an OVI account to access these features. Although I did create an account, I didn't find myself intrigued enough to try out the services. I'd recommend you to see for yourself whether you need these services or not.

Back on the desktop, again, there are three more workspaces besides this one—yes, just like you have four virtual desktops on a GNU/Linux desktop. Simply swap your finger on the screen horizontally to go to the next one. Ain't it great?

So, like on your desktop computer, customise these for your different sets of task loads. Figures 2, 3 and 4 show the way I've customised each of my workspaces:

- Figure 2 – three favourite contacts (the ones with the pictures), icons for *Conversations* (IM, SMS, Twitter), *Contacts* (address book), *E-mail* and *Phone*; besides a widget that shows me the current

processor and RAM usage.

- Figure 3 – Twitter and Facebook widgets, and another one to control my media player.
- Figure 4 – an AP (Associated Press) ticker to keep myself updated of the breaking news, weather applet and GPS location.

Customising the desktops is easy and very intuitive. Just tap an empty place on the screen, and you get a drop-down from the top right corner, with an icon of a 'gear'. Tap that, and the top portion of the desktop changes into a horizontal panel with the *Desktop menu* (Figure 5).

Tap the menu, and you get a drop-down with different items—add an application shortcut, add bookmark, change the desktop background, change the desktop theme, add a contact, add widgets, and manage views (which basically lets you select the number of views, and four is the maximum you can have). See Figure 6.

As you can also see in the screenshot, a very cool visual effect